Clout City: Hollywood Music — Milestones and Versions (v1)

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This document splits the Hollywood Music build into versions that each go live on their own, starting with a 24-hour teaser. The other documents define the full game; this one decides what ships when. The biggest difference from Clout City's plan: **the performance game is the riskiest piece, so it gets proven on a cheap Android phone in the first week, before anything is built on top of it.**

Rules every version follows (unchanged from Clout City)

1. **Every version is live and usable** at the real web address, on a low-end Android phone; unfinished features show a witty "Coming soon" card.
2. **Player data is built properly from day one;** only visuals and placeholder content may be temporary.
3. **Rules come from the documents.** If a version needs a rule to change, the document changes first.
4. **Nothing is promised that isn't built.**
5. **One version at a time.** Done means tested on your phone and merged.

Version overview

Seven versions, about 9 to 12 weeks to launch. Reuse is the main speed-up: port Clout City's modules (auth, profiles, invites, HUD shell, Shop, Net Worth, bills, World State, Stripe, chat, Story Studio) rather than rebuilding them.

Version	Name	What players get	Time
v0.1	Tap In	Browse Echo Flats, sign up, make an artist, see their home, invite friends	24 hours
v0.1.5	Lab	A hidden test page: one song on the note highway, with calibration (not public)	2 to 3 days
v0.2	First Show	The full performance game at Open Mic and Bar, the tutorial, the first open mic, fame, the leaderboard	1.5 to 2 weeks

Version	Name	What players get	Time
v0.3	Echo Flats	The neighborhood, The Rusty Amp and The Basement, the band, the economy, three more songs, hunts	2 weeks
v0.4	Stories	The News app and the pilot (loaded, not started), The Marquee and crowd calls, the last two songs, city news	1.5 to 2 weeks
v0.5	Money and Social	Real-money purchases, monuments and postcards, chat, crushes, date nights	1 to 2 weeks
v1.0	Launch	Real art, security and legal review, soft launch, then the pilot	1 to 2 weeks

Song rollout

The first four songs are produced with an AI music tool whose terms grant full commercial rights, through the song pipeline (New Features Spec section 7). Songs 5 and 6 are still open: AI or commissioned, decided before v0.4.

Song	Made by	Needed for	Ships with
A placeholder loop (not shipped to players)	AI	Building and testing the engine	v0.1.5
1. Open Mic Night (Be Nice)	AI	The tutorial and first open mic	v0.2
2. Rent's Due (Again)	AI	Second starting song	v0.2
3. My Ex Started a Podcast	AI	Local Act unlock	v0.3
4. Echo Flats, 3 AM	AI	Rusty Amp goal	v0.3
5. Opening Act Forever	Open	Buzzing unlock	v0.4
6. Overnight Sensation (Ten Years Later)	Open	Headliner unlock	v0.4
Page Fourteen (story song)	Open	The pilot	v0.4

Each song needs its stems (backing and lead) and four charts. Charts for songs 1 and 2 need only Open Mic and Bar in v0.2; their Club and Theater charts arrive with those venues.

Place rollout

The 19 places arrive in three waves so each version needs art only for what it uses.

Wave	Ships with	Places	New templates
1	v0.2	The three homes, The Grind	Apartment, café, stage
2	v0.3	The Rusty Amp, The Basement, Riff & Ruin, Echo Room Studios, El Cometa, Starlite Diner, Vantage rooftop, Fresh Flats Market, Hotel Valencia valet, Backlot 9, Lookout Park	Store, studio (stage reused)
3	v0.4 to v0.5	The Marquee and Echo Flats Precinct (v0.4); the CLOUTWOOD sign and the Wall of Almost (v0.5)	Landmark plaza

Unbuilt places don't appear on the map except as v0.1's pins; adding a place is data and art, never code; daily tasks draw only from places that exist.

v0.1 "Tap In" (24 hours)

An early-access teaser: claim your artist name, see yourself at home, recruit your crew before the town opens.

Feature	What it does	Spec
Guest map	The illustrated Echo Flats map (one placeholder illustration is fine), pan and two zooms, pins for The Grind, The Rusty Amp, The Basement, The Marquee and the homes, locked districts under clouds, the Halo Dome lit. Any tap opens sign-up	Clarifications 3; Design Guide C46 to C49
Sign-up	Email magic link, 18+ checkbox, terms and privacy links	Clarifications 1
Invite capture	The invite code survives sign-up	Clout City Clarifications 7
Mini creator	Name, the Look options, a scene chip and an instrument choice; the avatar updates instantly	Clarifications 1

Feature	What it does	Spec
Home screen	HUD, side column, stats panel, nav. Home and Map work; everything else shows "Coming soon." Fame and money show "—"	Clarifications 2
3D artist at home	The ported Clout City 3D character in one room, idle animation	Clout City Design Guide C38
Invite screen	Personal link, share button, "2 of 5 joined," "Rewards unlock when the town opens"	Clout City Clarifications 7
Legal pages	Basic terms and privacy, marked for lawyer review	—

Not in v0.1: shows, the performance game, fame, the economy, stories, payments, chat, music.

24-hour plan: hours 0 to 2 you set up the repo (with these docs, the Clout City docs for reference, and CLAUDE.md), Vercel and Supabase, and generate the map and room images; hours 2 to 18 Claude Code ports auth, profiles, invites and the HUD shell, then builds the map, creator and home; hours 18 to 24 invite screen, legal pages, phone testing and launch.

You test: a fresh browser lands on the map; tapping anything opens sign-up and the 18+ box is required; the magic link works; a friend's sign-up shows in your crew count; creator choices update the avatar instantly; nothing is blank or broken on a cheap Android phone.

v0.1.5 "Lab" (2 to 3 days, not public)

A hidden page (`/lab`, admin only) that proves the performance game before anything depends on it.

- The note highway at Open Mic and Bar with one AI placeholder loop and a hand-made chart.
- Tap and hold notes, timing grades, the multiplier, the Crowd meter, and a bare results screen.
- Calibration (C64) with the saved per-device offset.
- A debug overlay: frame rate, measured audio latency, and each hit's timing error in ms.

You test, on your phone and a low-end Android phone: notes stay in sync with the music for a whole song; taps feel on time after calibration; at least 50 fps; switching tabs pauses and resumes cleanly. If timing feels off on Android, fix it here; nothing else starts until it

feels good.

v0.2 "First Show" (1.5 to 2 weeks)

The complete first session: link → creator → tutorial → first open mic → leaderboard.

- **The rest of the creator:** the Sound step (instrument, scene, band name), Birth lottery (C$4,000 to C$8,000 plus a starter instrument) and Home (three rooms).
- **Welcome and five tooltips;** the protected first open mic with the tutorial song; calibration right after.
- **The performance game at Open Mic and Bar** (C50 to C57 minus crowd calls): taps, holds, Hype notes and the Hype button, streaks, callouts, the Crowd meter and booed-off state, results and stars. Practice at home.
- **Songs 1 and 2** (AI), with Open Mic and Bar charts, through the song pipeline.
- **Wave 1 places:** the homes and The Grind with its stage scene (C59) and show row (C58); one paid show per venue per day.
- **Fame, fans, the leaderboard** (Echo Flats and Crew), invite rewards paid retroactively for v0.1 invites, Google sign-in, the PWA prompt, background music and show audio settings.

Players from v0.1 finish the Sound, Birth lottery and Home steps on their next visit, then get the tutorial; name, look and crew carry over.

You test: a friend with no help goes from link to a finished open mic and the leaderboard; songs stay in sync on a cheap Android phone; a bad performance at Open Mic never boos you off; one paid show per day is enforced and practice is unlimited.

v0.3 "Echo Flats" (2 weeks)

Echo Flats becomes a place to live and climb: the full daily loop of shows, work, band and spending.

- **The location system** from data, with wave 2 places (11) and their cards, lore and actions; placeholder art is fine.
- **The Rusty Amp (Bar) and The Basement (Club)** with fame-tier gates; Club difficulty adds chords and power strums; Club charts for songs 1 and 2.
- **Songs 3 and 4** (AI) with Open Mic, Bar and Club charts; song unlocks by fame tier and goals.
- **The band:** the Musicians Wanted board, hiring, weekly band pay, Chemistry, rehearsal (the call-and-response mini-game, C56 and C63), quitting and letting go; The Basement's two-bandmate requirement; bandmates on stage.

- **The economy:** Energy, Mood and Confidence rules; dining in three tiers; groceries and home cooking; day jobs; the Deals app with three tiers gated by fans; daily tasks paying cash; fame cooldowns; club nights.
- **The Shop** (six categories, cosmetic instruments and gear, Instrument tab in Your Look), Net Worth with 60% selling, weekly bills with band pay, missed-rent rules.
- **Travel** (Go there, four modes, skippable trip view), the two clocks, decorative vehicles.
- **Treasure hunts, simplified:** eight scene tracks through the Hunt tab and "Ask around," reviewed in the Story Studio (hunt review screen).

You test: a week of play with time travel. Rent and one bandmate are affordable from shows and jobs; reaching Buzzing feels earned but not grindy; a bandmate left unpaid actually quits; Club charts feel fair on a phone; no daily task is ever impossible. Tune venue fees, fan rates and deal multipliers with the economy spreadsheet.

v0.4 "Stories" (1.5 to 2 weeks)

The story system and the top of the P1 ladder. The pilot is loaded and tested but not started.

- **The World State layer** ported from Clout City, plus `show_slot` and `song_injection` (World State brief).
- **The News app** with beat cards, "Previously," catch-up, the archive and shadow guesses; predictions with live results, rewards and badges.
- **"Who Cancelled the Midnight Saints?"** and its three side arcs as data (side arcs unlock in v0.5); wave 3 places The Marquee and Echo Flats Precinct; the story song "Page Fourteen."
- **The Marquee (Theater)** with crowd calls in the performance game; Theater charts for every song.
- **Songs 5 and 6** through the song pipeline.
- **The Story Studio** grows story review (both gates, editor-pass report, scheduling, preview with time travel, pause and retire), **song review**, news review and the chat report queue.
- **City news, the recurring cast and NPC lines** at places (New Features Spec); hunts move onto the World State layer with NPC clues and riff challenges.
- The validation script, time travel and debug panel.

You test: step through all 10 days with time travel: every beat, effect, cancelled slot, injected song, chatter phase and prediction fires on the right day; P1 closes before Day 7; the pop-up show spawns at The Rusty Amp; "Page Fourteen" appears in setlists on Day 7 and stays for players who played it; nothing changes how a show is scored.

v0.5 "Money and Social" (1 to 2 weeks)

Real money and player-to-player features, in Stripe test mode until v1.0. Mostly ported from Clout City.

- One Stripe Checkout flow for exclusive events ($3.99), collector instruments and outfits, the pilot's three side arcs ($2.99) and monument postcards ($0.99); entitlements by SKU; refunds with fame clawback.
- **Monuments:** the CLOUTWOOD sign lookout and the Wall of Almost as full locations with the landmark plaza, NPCs, activities and postcards; the Collection with the new Show cards tab.
- **Chat** (10 a day, filter, block, report), then **crushes, crush invites and date nights**, including "Come to my show."
- The show share card (C65) and analytics for the success metrics (first show, invites, day-1 return, shows per day, finish rate, beat opens, predictions, purchases).

You test: each product's test purchase unlocks it, a replayed payment doesn't duplicate it, a refund removes it and its fame; a chat report reaches the Story Studio queue; a "Come to my show" date pays only after both players have done their part.

v1.0 "Launch" (1 to 2 weeks, then the soft launch)

- **Real art** for the map (day and night), every place, the stage scenes, avatar instruments and stage sprites, album tiles, postcards, logo and icon.
- **Final audio** for all six songs, mastered to the same loudness, and a final timing pass on every chart.
- **Performance work** for low-end Android, especially shows.
- **Reviews:** security (including the Story Studio's admin-only access), lawyer-reviewed terms, privacy and 18+ wording, name checks for every place and the CLOUTWOOD sign, and a check of the AI music tool's license for every AI song. Stripe live mode confirmed with one real $0.99 purchase and refund.

Then, in order: soft launch to 20 to 50 people for 1 to 2 weeks, tuning the economy and chart difficulty from real play; approve the next, lighter story ("Who's Vexa's Plus-One?"); set the pilot's start to a Sunday in the Story Studio and plan the push around Day 1.

Running versions in Claude Code

Save this as `docs/07-milestones-and-versions.md` in the `hollywood-music` repository, with the other Hollywood Music docs and the Clout City docs in `docs/clout-city/` for reference. Add a "Current version" line to CLAUDE.md.

To start a version, open a session at claude.ai/code on the repo and send:

```
Read CLAUDE.md and docs/07-milestones-and-versions.md. We're building
[version and name].
Where a feature exists in Clout City, port it and change only what the
Hollywood docs change.
Build only what's in that version's scope; anything else gets a "Coming soon"
card.
First, list the steps you'll take, in plain language, and wait for my OK.
After each step, open a pull request with its Vercel preview link and what to
test on my phone.
```

To ship it: test every item on your phone and a low-end Android phone, merge, ask Claude Code for plain-language release notes, update "Current version," then start the next. If a version runs long, move scope from the bottom of its list to the next version; never skip the timing tests.